

SUPERIOR S.E.5A

When the British-built S.E.5a entered the war in 1917 it proved itself superior to all its German opponents. Faster than the Sopwith Camel and easier to fly, it developed a formidable reputation in the hands of celebrated aces like Edward Mannock. Designed by H.P. Folland at the Royal Aircraft Factory in Farnborough, it combined a strong airframe with good, solid performance. Over 5,000 were produced.

Laminated
wooden propeller

Metal
engine cowling

Wing-mounted
Lewis gun

Faired headrest
behind cockpit

Elevator

SKILLED HANDS

Workers construct S.E.5s at the Royal Aircraft Factory, Farnborough, Britain. Despite mass production, making aircraft remained a labor-intensive job, as it had been in the artisan workshops of the prewar era. Processes such as attaching the wire rigging needed a high level of skill and were very time-consuming.